City of Saint Paul

Meeting Minutes

City Council

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, May 6, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:32 PM

Present 6 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

Absent 1 - Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

COMMUNICATIONS & RECEIVE/FILE

1 AO 26-25 Establishing one (1) new project through the Neighborhood STAR Year-Round Program as adopted via City Council Resolution #s- RES 26-632.

Received and Filed

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Council President Noecker stated that Items 10 and 11 would be taken separately.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

2 RES 26-476 Approving the City's cost of providing Removal of Diseased and/or Dangerous

Tree(s) in February 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for June 2, 2026 and City Council public hearing for July 15, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. 2604T, Assessment No. 269003)

Adopted

3 RES 26-642 Authorizing the City to enter into an agreement with the Metropolitan Council for the METRO G Line Bus Rapid Transit Project.

Adopted

4 RES 26-664 Approving the application for change of ownership to the Liquor On Sale - 291 or more seats, Liquor On Sale - Sunday, Liquor On Sale - 2AM Closing, Entertainment (B), Tobacco Shop & Liquor Off Sale licenses now held by SPH Grill LLC d/b/a The St Paul Grill (License ID #DSIBLLIQ-000679-2026) for the premises located at 350 Market Street.

Adopted

5 RES 26-665 Approving the expansion of the Liquor Outdoor Service Area of the existing Liquor On Sale - 100 seats or less, Liquor On Sale - Sunday, Liquor Outdoor Service Area (Patio), Entertainment (A), and Gambling Location licenses for 620 Club LLC d/b/a 620 Club (License ID #20240001045) for the premises located at 620 7th Street West.

Adopted

6 RES 26-670 Authorizing the Fire Department to apply for the Capitol Region Watershed District maintenance grant.

Adopted

7 RES 26-673 Preliminary Order setting the date of Public Hearing for June 10, 2026 to consider approval of the improvement to the alley bounded by Hatch, Orchard, Kilburn and Ryde. (File No. 19266, Assessment No. 255001)

Adopted

8 RES 26-676 Approving the agreements with Lime (Neutron Holdings, Inc. dba Lime) and Spin (Pheenix USH LLC, dba Spin) to provide electric scooter and electric-assisted bicycle sharing services for the 2026 season, with the option to renew for two additional one-year terms.

Adopted

9 RES 26-695 Accepting the gift of travel, lodging, and related expenses from NACTO and supporting funders for Steve Dodge to attend the Designing Cities Conference on equitable, safe, and sustainable multi-modal transportation.

Adopted

12 RES 26-704 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Samuel Xiong, Phoenix Vang, and Lay Wah to three-year terms on Mayor's Advisory Committee for People with Disabilities.

Adopted

13 RES 26-709 Accepting temporary easements and authorizing payment to property owners for the Woodward Alley Reconstruction Project.

Adopted

14 RES 26-711 Authorizing the City to apply for the Knight Cities Challenge from Knight Foundation to support a range of innovative projects to address community needs around expanding economic opportunity and growing cultural vibrancy.

Adopted

15 RES 26-712 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Paw Wah Wah, Amria Abdirahman, Jaclyn Nicholas and Alexander Knoll to the Climate Justice Advisory Board.

Adopted

16 RES 26-727 Authorizing the Saint Paul Police Department to accept a bequest from the Nancy E. Sittard Irrevocable Trust for the purchase, training, and care for police dogs.

Adopted

17 RES 26-728 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and the Tri-Council (LIUNA Laborers, Local 563; General Drivers, Local 120; and Operating Engineers, Local 49) for a 2026 interim wage increase during their reorganization transition.

Laid over to May 13, 2026

18 RES 26-731 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Emily Peterson to the Police Civilian Internal Affairs Review Commission.

Adopted

19 RES 26-735 Approving the application for change of ownership to the Wine On Sale and Malt On Sale (Strong) license (License ID #DSIBLLIQ-000661-2026) now held by Moon House Thai Cuisine LLC d/b/a Moon House Thai Cuisine for the premises located at 1665 Rice Street.

Adopted

20 RES 26-737 Authorizing the Fire Department to accept the donation of 500 combination smoke alarms/CO detectors valued at $29,985 from Kidde.

Adopted

21 RES 26-738 Approving the application for change of ownership to the Motor Vehicle Salvage Dealer (License ID #DSIBLAUTO-000680-2026) and Second Hand Dealer - Motor Vehicle (License ID #DSIBLAUTO-000714-2026) licenses now held by Atlas Automotive Recycling LLC d/b/a Atlas Automotive Recycling LLC for the premises located at 228 Sycamore Street West.

Adopted

22 RES 26-744 Extending the appointment of Jardine, Logan & O'Brien, P.L.L.P., as Special Counsel for purposes of providing legal advice, counsel, and representation in civil lawsuits involving the City.

Adopted

23 RES 26-745 Approving the Three Year Lease between the City and Second Chance Recycling at 60 Sycamore Street.

Adopted

24 RES 26-756 Correcting a scrivener's error in Ord 25-78 which established Chapter 15 of the Administrative Code to define structured quarterly reporting requirements for certain personnel vacancies and overtime utilization.

Adopted

25 RES 26-758 Accepting the gift of registration, meals, hotel and travel expenses from Local Progress for Council Vice President Nelsie Yang to attend the 2026 Local Progress National Convening.

Adopted

26 RES 26-767 Approving the Use of Grant Funds Through the Ward 1 Neighborhood STAR Year-Round Program for Camphor Memorial United Methodist Church Systems Investments Project.

Adopted

27 RES 26-607 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement for the 2026 Wage and Fringe Adjustment between the City of Saint Paul and the International Brotherhood of Electrical Workers, Local 110.

Adopted

28 RES 26-638 Approving the Memorandum of Agreement for the 2026 Wage and Fringe Adjustment between the City of Saint Paul and the United Association of Steamfitters Pipefitters Local No 455.

Adopted

29 RES 26-645 Changing the rate of pay for Legal Support Specialist (formerly Legal Secretary) from Grade 030 to Grade 031 of EG 01, AFSCME Clerical.

Adopted

30 RES 26-655 Establishing the rate of pay for Solid Waste Services Crew Leader in Grade 021 of EG 71, Tri-Council Laborers/Groundsworkers.

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

10 RES 26-700 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Alliana Golds, Joua Lor, and Mary Wah to three-year terms on the Humans Rights and Equal Economic Opportunity Commission.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

11 RES 26-703 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Michelle Collins, Ollie Grotzke, and Hser Wah to two-year terms on the Labor Standards Advisory Committee.

Oliver Grotzke gave remarks.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

SUSPENSION ITEM

RES 26-619 Urging European financial institutions to divest from companies that enable the United States Department of Homeland Security (DHS) and Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) and supporting the delegation of Twin Cities residents advocating for this divestment. (to be withdrawn)

Withdrawn

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

PUBLIC HEARINGS

Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

31 Ord 26-25 Amending Chapter 66 of the Legislative Code to correct a scrivener's error related to allowing additional lot coverage for providing functional green roof

space.

Councilmember Jost moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Laid over to May 13, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

32 Ord 26-26 Updating Chapter 310 of the Legislative Code (Title XXIX) pertaining to Uniform License Procedures to extend payment of license renewal fees owed in calendar year 2026.

Councilmember Johnson moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Laid over to May 13, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

33 RES PH 26-103 Authorizing issuance of and awarding the sale of General Obligation Various Purpose Bonds, Series 2026B and levying a tax for the Series 2026B Bonds.

Neal Younghans from the Office of Financial Services gave a staff report.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval of Version 2.

Adopted as amended

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

34 RES PH 26-111 Authorizing the issuance of and awarding the sale of General Obligation Street Reconstruction Bonds, Series 2026C; and levying a tax for the payment of the Series 2026C Bonds.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval of Version 2.

Adopted as amended

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

35 RES PH 26-114 Authorizing a transfer of appropriations between the Saint Paul City Council General Fund and Special Projects Fund in the amount of $50,000 to align Audit Committee spending with past practices.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

36 RES PH 26-115 Authorizing the City Council to utilize fund balance, accumulated and unspent in 2025, to increase the financing and spending budgets in the City Council Special Projects Fund by $245,050.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

37 RES PH 26-48 Accepting grant funds, authorizing execution of a grant agreement (with indemnity obligations and other documents related thereto) and amending the operating budget with respect to the City's sponsorship of a Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development (DEED) Contamination Cleanup grant for the benefit Face to Face at 1170 Arcade Street North. (District 5, Ward 6).

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

38 RES PH 26-102 Authorizing the acceptance of $298,000 from the Minnesota Department of

Commerce's Microgrids at Community Lifeline Facilities Grant Program for Oxford Community Center; and authorizing the execution of a grant agreement and amending the 2026 Grant Budget.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

39 RES PH 26-109 Approving an Interim Use Permit for to allow temporary cellular telephone antennas on a 76' monopole tower at 732 Central Avenue West.

Chris Hong, City Planner, gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Two people spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

40 RES PH 26-96 Approving five (5) applications of El Burrito Mercado for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for Las Series de Verano de El Burrito Mercado, including Fiesta Mexicana en el Patio event on the Fridays of May 8, June 5, July 10, August 7, and September 11, 2026; Ritmo y Flow Brunch en el Patio event on the Saturdays of May 9, June 13, July 11, and August 15, 2026; Puro Tex-Mex Party en el Patio event on the Saturdays of May 30, June 27, July 25, and August 29, 2026; Baile En Mi Barrio event on the Saturdays of June 13, July 18, and August 8, 2026; and Pop-Up Tianguis event on the Sundays of June 28 and August 9, 2026, all at 175 Cesar Chavez Street - El Burrito Mercado.

Councilmember Noecker moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

41 RES PH 26-78 Approving the application of Ordway Center for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for a Flint Hills Family event on May 27-30, 2026, at 109 West 4th Street - Rice Park and 379 Saint Peter Street - Landmark Plaza.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

42 RES PH 26-79 Approving the application of University of Saint Thomas - Campus Life for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for a Tommie Fest event on Friday, May 15, 2026, at 2115 Summit Avenue - University of Saint Thomas, John P. Monahan Plaza.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

43 RES PH 26-98 Approving the application of Dual Citizen Brewing Company for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for Friends of the Mississippi Benefit Concert - "Music for the Mississippi" event on Saturday, May 30, 2026, at 725 Raymond Avenue - Dual Citizen Brewing.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

44 RES PH 26-99 Approving the application of Skinner's Pub for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for a Music on the Patio event series on Tuesdays from June 2, 2026, through September 29, 2026, at 919 Randolph Avenue - Skinner's Pub.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

45 RES PH 26-101 Approving the application of Wabasha Brewing for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for Live Music at Wabasha event series on the Saturdays of May 9, May 23, June 6, June 20, July 4, August 1, and August 15, 2026, at 429 Wabasha Street South - the patio of Wabasha Brewing.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

46 RES PH 26-104 Approving the application of Ramsey County Regional Railroad Authority for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for the Train Days Music Festival event on Saturday, June 6, 2026, at 240 Kellogg Boulevard East - Union Depot.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

47 RLH SAO 26-32 Appeal of Michael Corcoran to a Summary Abatement Order and Vehicle Abatement Order at 1478 AMES AVENUE.

Adopted

48 RLH SAO 26-28 Appeal of Emmett Owens, Jr. to a Summary Abatement Order, Vehicle Abatement Order and Correction Notice at 233 BATES AVENUE.

Adopted

49 RLH TA 25-410 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 511 BAY STREET. (File No. J2601R1, Assessment No. 268602) (Amend to delete)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

50 RLH TA 25-429 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1077 BLAIR AVENUE. (File No. J2526R1, Assessment No. 258591) (Amend to delete)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

51 RLH TA 26-98 Deleting the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1093 BREEN STREET. (File No. CG25Q3B4-1, Assessment No. 260135)

Adopted

52 RLH TA 25-375 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 828 ENGLEWOOD AVENUE. (File No. J2526R3, Assessment No. 258593) (Amend to delete)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

53 RLH RR 26-3 Ordering the rehabilitation or razing and removal of the structures at 118 MANITOBA AVENUE within fifteen (15) days after the March 18, 2026, City Council Public Hearing.

Adopted as amended (granted 180 days)

54 RLH VO 26-18 Appeal of Ashray Gupta to a Fire Inspection Correction Notice, which includes vacate order, at 251 MARIA AVENUE.

Adopted

55 RLH VBR 26-6 Appeal of Lynda Thurstin to a Notice of Condemnation and Order to Remain Vacant plus vacant building status at 767 MARYLAND AVENUE EAST.

Adopted

56 RLH VBR 26-7 Appeal of Lori Kroeger to a Notice of Condemnation and Order to Remain Vacant plus vacant building designation at 1066 MATILDA STREET.

Adopted

57 RLH SAO 26-31 Appeal of Michelle Skinner to a Summary of Abatement Order at 110 RUTH STREET.

Adopted

58 RLH TA 25-415 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 476 SHERBURNE AVENUE. (File No. J2601R2, Assessment No. 268603) (Amend to delete)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

59 RLH FCO 26-33 Appeal of Sei Korti to Inspection Orders at 561 VAN BUREN AVENUE.

Adopted

60 RLH SAO 26-33 Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 412 WHITE BEAR AVENUE NORTH in Council File RLH SAO 26-25.

Adopted as amended (nuisance abated, matter resolved)

61 RLH AR 26-17 Ratifying the assessment for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or Hazardous Structure from the month of December 2025. (File No. J2602C, Assessment No. 262001)

Adopted

62 RLH AR 26-18 Ratifying the assessment for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or Hazardous Structure from the month of December 2025. (File No. J2603C, Assessment No. 262002)

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:05 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
The City Council is paperless which saves the environment and reduces expenses. The agendas and Council files are all available on the Web (see below). Council members use mobile devices to review the files during the meeting. Using a mobile device greatly reduces costs since most agendas, including the documents attached to files, are over 1000 pages when printed.

Web
Meetings are available on the Council's website. Email notification and web feeds (RSS) of newly released minutes, agendas, and meetings are available by subscription. Visit www.stpaul.gov/council for meeting videos and updated copies of the agendas, minutes, and supporting documents.

Cable
Meetings are live on St Paul Channel 18 and replayed at various times. Check your local listings.